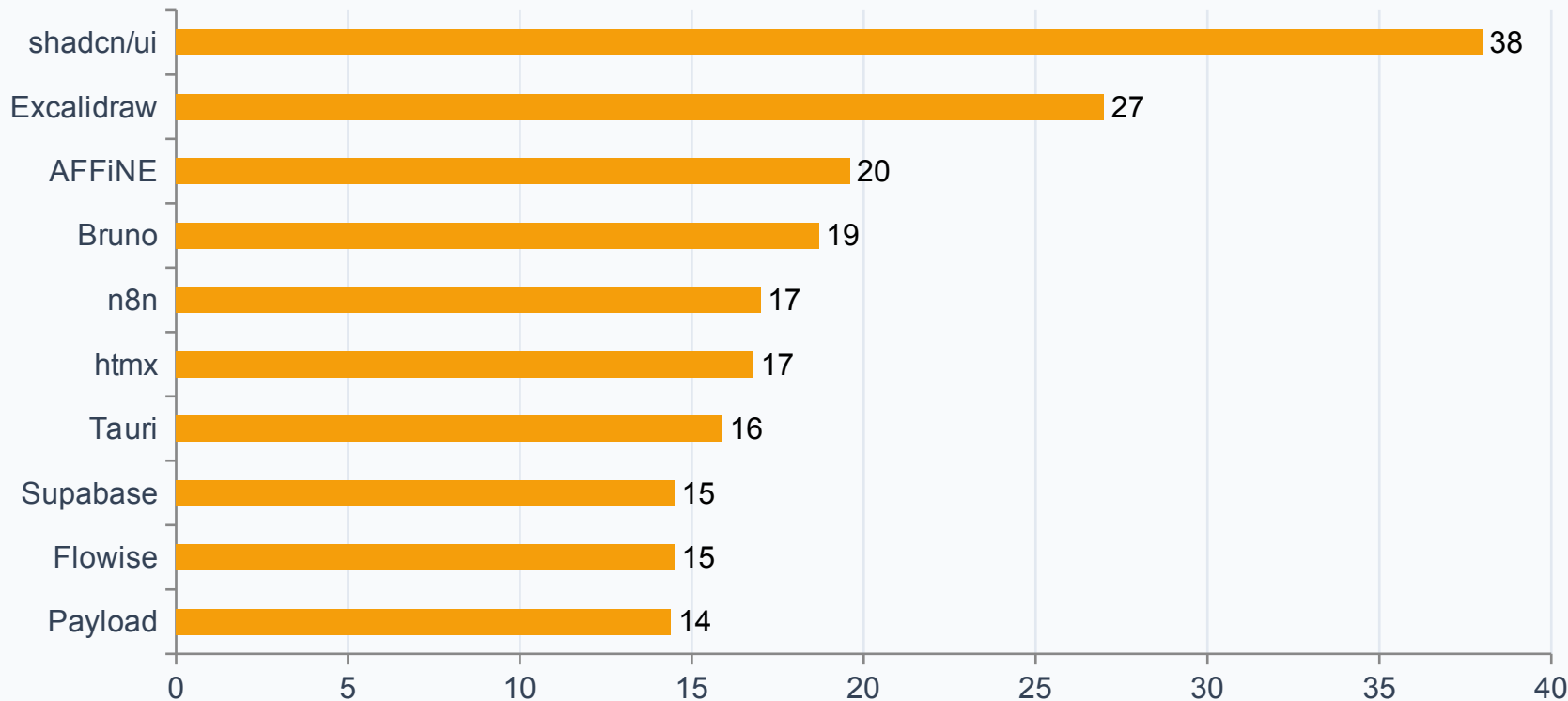


2024 JavaScript Rising Stars: The Year's Hottest Projects by GitHub Stars

9th Edition • Analyzing GitHub stars added in 2024 from Best of JS

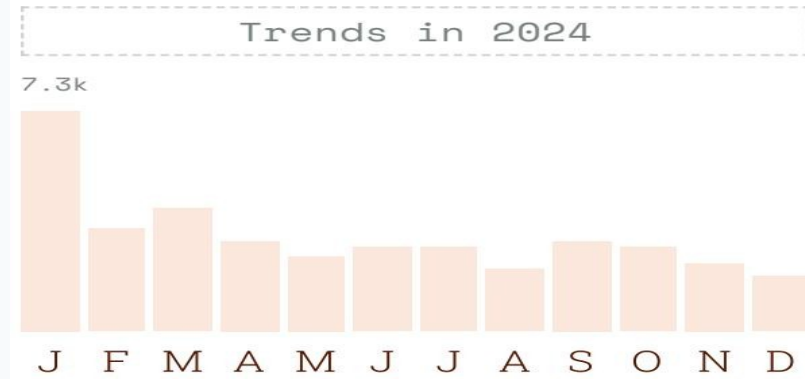
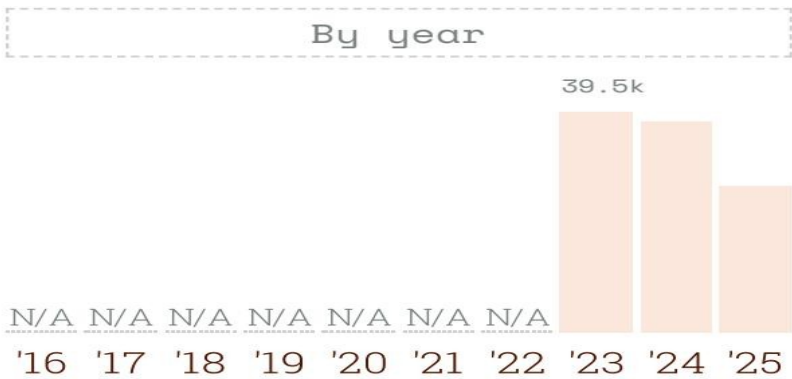
shadcn/ui Leads Overall with +38k Stars, Followed by Excalidraw and AFFiNE



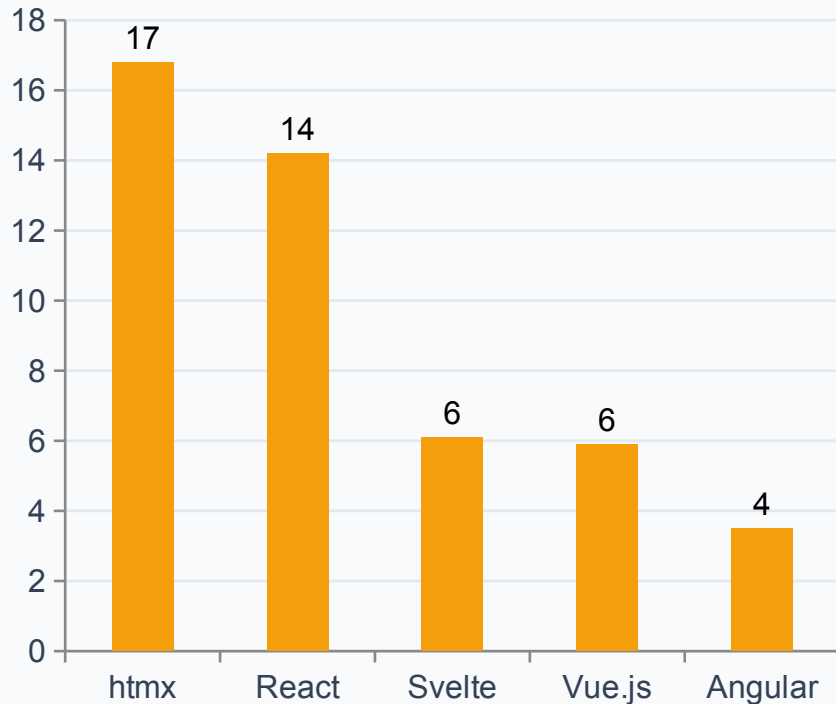
shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win for the Second Consecutive Year

Sustaining Extraordinary Momentum

- N/A through 2022, 39.5k in 2023, 38.0k in 2024 (77.5k total)
- Key 2024 features: Charts (Recharts), Themes (CSS variables), Blocks, Sidebar
- New CLI with multi-framework support (Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel)
- Spawning an ecosystem: Motion-Primitives, Magic UI, and Vercel v0 integration



htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework by Stars Added



htmx Philosophy

- Extends HTML with hx-* attributes for data fetching/interactivity.
- Ideal for server-driven apps and progressive enhancement.

React 19 Release

- Introduced Server Components, Server Functions, new hooks.
- React is evolving from a library into a "specification for frameworks."

React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload Dominate

Top 5 React Projects (Stars Added)

1. shadcn/ui	+38.0k
2. Excalidraw	+27.0k
3. Payload	+14.4k
4. Magic UI	+13.2k
5. Next.js	+12.1k

Ecosystem Evolution

- React 19 makes it clear that React is more than a UI library.
- Multiple frameworks (Next.js, Remix) interpret React's Server Components and Server Functions differently.
- This solidifies React's role as a foundational full-stack framework specification.

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev Lead Growth

Top 5 Vue Projects (Stars Added)

1. Nuxt	+6.2k
2. PrimeVue	+5.4k
3. Slidev	+4.7k
4. shadcn-vue	+4.1k
5. VitePress	+3.7k

Maturing Ecosystem

- Wave of high-quality UI libraries signals growing ecosystem confidence.
- Active release cycle and regular performance improvements noted by the core team.

Vue 3.5 Overhaul

- Reactivity system reworked for performance and efficiency.
- Implemented the lighter "alien-signals" approach in the main branch.

AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser-Based Innovation Shape 2024

AI Integration

n8n (+17.0k) & Flowise (+14.5k)
Native AI in workflows and visual LLM flow builders. AI is now table stakes.

Backend-as-a-Service

Supabase (+14.5k) & AFFiNE (+19.6k)
Open-source alternatives to Firebase and Notion showing huge momentum.

Desktop Apps

Tauri (+15.9k)
Continued push for lighter, faster desktop/mobile apps built with web technologies.

Browser Innovation

PGlite & WebVM
Bringing Postgres and full virtual machines entirely into the browser via WebAssembly.

Key Takeaways: What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

- 1. Component Ownership Wins**
shadcn/ui's model of owning component code proves its staying power over traditional imports.
- 2. HTML-First is Serious**
htmx validates server-driven, low-JavaScript architectures as a top choice.
- 3. React as a Specification**
React 19 solidifies its transition from a UI library to a foundational framework spec.
- 4. AI is Table Stakes**
Top projects natively integrate AI, showing it's an expectation rather than a feature.
- 5. Vue Reaches Maturity**
A robust wave of UI libraries and performance overhauls show Vue is flourishing.